find wealthy patrons who would commission a variety of artworks from the artist. A number of writers also found inspiration in Venice and Milan. An oligarchy is defined as a power structure ruled by a small number of people. It was an oligarchy known as the Great Council that ruled Venice while a succession of strong and influential dukes ruled Milan.

Giotto is known as one of the most famous painters from the early Renaissance. Ghiberti's work on creating new perception was revolutionary in the sculpting world. Other artists like Donatello and Botticelli refined these methods with further development. New inventions like the world had never seen before came about during the latter part of this time period, referred to as the High Renaissance. Some of the greatest artists including Michelangelo, Raphael, and Leonardo da Vinci appeared and created works that are famous to this day. The printing press was invented, which allowed literature and art to become an integral part of daily life. Some of the greatest writers of the day including Niccolo Machiavelli, Pico and Boccaccio had the tools available to spread their writings and ideas easily.

As great as the Renaissance was, there were some hiccups that lead to its demise. In 1494, Italy was invaded by the French. For some time, various European powers strove to carve off pieces of Italy for themselves. Rome was sacked in 1527 by foreigners and during the reign of the Holy Roman Emperor Charles V, the Renaissance was finally over. Charles V implemented a number of measures that limited economic progression. The Church was also not a fan of the artists and imposed strict penalties that eventually became law. Italy was no longer the center of the greatest artistic age the world had ever seen.

Nonetheless, a number of famous inventions were made during this time. In the 15th century, Leonardo da Vinci created the robotic knight, which can be considered to be the first mechanical robot. It was made from armor in which a complex gear and pulley mechanism was contained. The robotic knight was put on display for the people to see at a party held by the Duke of Milan. In the early 16th century, the violin was invented by Andrea Amati. Although something like a violin existed before his time, Amati is known to have created the first violin to have four strings. Modern violins